

THE OVERCOMING OF NEGATIVITY

Greetings and blessings for every one of my friends here. I shall immediately proceed with this lecture, which is a continuation of the last one. For those friends here who have not heard, or better yet, studied the last lecture, it will be difficult to really comprehend this sequence. We were discussing the importance of mind, of consciousness, and its creative aspects and powers. We were also talking about negative creation, which is an ongoing process in every human being. For, if you were free from negative creation, if you were not negatively involved with creation, you would not be human; you would not live on this plane of consciousness, which expresses a certain degree of development. Man is, in general, to some degree quite free so that he creates constructively to quite an extent. But to varying degrees, negative creation is still ongoing in his psyche. This means that it is man's task on this sphere to struggle out of it and to free himself further and further from the ensnarlment of negativity. It is not easy, for the fascination with any creative process takes hold of man so that he wants to remain in it. Simultaneously, he becomes involved with any number of vicious circles that seem difficult to break through. It is my task now to help you step by step to further break the hold on your negative involvement with distorted creative processes.

I shall continue with the specific aspects which this pathwork is so particularly concerned with. Many of my friends begin to find within themselves the truth, the fact, of their own negativity and even that their negativity is deliberate -- and are able to see how they hang on to it. That this step has been reached is of tremendous significance. There is no greater difference conceivable than between human beings who know that they create their own fate, that they wish to be negative, that, no matter how undesirable it seems, they still want to retain this attitude of being negative, and those who are ignorant of this fact.

Anyone who is on any path that genuinely leads to the realization of the universal self must come to this insight about himself. Otherwise, the path he takes leads to illusion and deals merely with theoretical speculation or an alienated idealization, and not a real live experience.

So, my friends, since you are human, every one of you is involved with negatively creating. Your deliberate negative attitudes and feelings, which you do not want to give up, are a creation. To believe that your unhappiness and your suffering is inflicted upon you by others, by life, is utter folly. It is mankind's insanity to believe that any unhappiness can accrue from something outside of or other than the self. You have known this theoretically a long, long time, for I have certainly harped on this fact of life. And you pay lip service to it. But there is a world of difference between the intellectual belief in this philosophy and the clear-cut realization that you indeed create negatively, that the very unhappiness you deplore and render others responsible for is caused by negative attitudes you really enjoy and want to maintain. If you ascribe your frustrations, your unfulfillment, or your pains to society, you are completely off beam. This does not mean that the ills you see in society do not actually exist. They do exist. But they could not really affect you if you

were not deeply and still unconsciously involved with contributing to those very ills of society you so much deplore, by your negativity which you express in your private life.

This truth may be hard to believe when you are still at the very beginning of such a path as this. But once you are really involved in it, you must come to see that it is just that way. You are never an innocent victim, and society itself is but the sum total, the product of yours and many other people's constant negative production and creation. This realization is at first shocking and painful, but only as long as you are unwilling to give up the negativity. In that case, you do need the illusion that others do it. You hope you can come to bliss without meeting that in you that makes it impossible. You hope to become a truly self-accepting and self-respecting human being without giving up all that which truly impairs your integrity. Thus you live the illusion that others are doing it to you, whom you can blame for it and who allegedly victimize you. This is one of the famous and very frequent "games" of pretense that have been uncovered by many of my friends in various forms. Once these illusions and the cheating intentions are abandoned, the realization of your own creative power -- constantly at work, though perhaps still mostly negatively -- is as wonderful a revelation and liberation as it was first a shock.

Now I would like to discuss the various steps necessary to work your way out of this maze of your own illusion and negative production, in which you seem to be so inextricably and inexorably caught. Evidently, the first step must be that you do find and determine and acknowledge and see and accept and observe your own negative attitudes, the destructive feelings, the subtle lies, the intention to cheat, the life defeating spiteful resistance to good feelings. All of these are negative creating. Since these lectures are particularly directed to my friends who work very personally and very dynamically toward their own growth, who work systematically in that direction, I could say that most of you have come to some extent in contact with this deliberate negative production. But it is important that you become more aware of it, more detachedly observant of it. This comprises the first step.

The second step is that you question, deep inside, your reaction, your feelings, to this negative production, whatever it may consist of in your particular case, as to its deliberate, chosen intent on your part. You will then see that you like it, find some sort of pleasure in it, and do not wish to give it up. I discussed in the last lecture the pleasurable aspect of creating, which applies also to negative creating. It is absolutely necessary that you feel this and admit it. Even though you somehow understand in general and vague terms that this is destructive and somehow wrong, you still are captivated by the perverse pleasure your own negative production gives you. This acknowledgment is essential. Without it, you cannot grow out of suffering, nor can you reach the spiritual selfhood you long for.

The third step is that the exact consequences and ramifications of your negative production must be painstakingly worked through without taking any detail, any effect, any side effect for granted or glossing over it. The realization and precise understanding of its harmful effects on you and on others must become very clear. It will not do if you assuage your guilt for all negative creation by telling yourself you only harm yourself. It must be seen that you cannot harm yourself without also harming others, no more than you can harm others without also harming you. This is not a law of retribution of a vindictive authority up in heaven. It is so because you are all, we are all, they are all, everyone is, the one universal self. So what happens to you must happen to everyone else, and vice versa. It is unthinkable that anything that adversely affects you does not affect others

as well. Self-hate, for example, always manifests also as the inability to love, or even the compulsion to hate, others. This is only one example. This, too, is not a theory. This, too, is found to be so, but only as you actually work through these steps.

The third step consists of seeing that the pleasure you derive from your negative production is never worth the exorbitant price you pay for it; that all you deplore most in yourself and in your life experience is a direct result of it; that you sacrifice joy, peace, self-esteem, inner security, expansion and growth, pleasure on all levels of your being, meaningful and fearless existence. All this and more can never be worth the perverse pleasure of your negative creation.

It must also be seen how your negative creation does affect others. It must be seen that some deep part of you knows this quite accurately and justifiedly feels guilty for it, makes you hate and punish yourself and rob yourself of the real satisfactions of life. You must come to see that guiltless living can only exist when negative creating is given up. Even the sincere and serious desire to do so will bring relief.

Still another aspect of step three is to reach for the understanding that the pleasure you derive from being destructive in your feelings and attitudes is not what has to be given up; that, in fact, this same pleasure will be transferred to positive creation, where you can expand joyfully and guiltlessly without the heavy price you pay in the negative situation, without sacrificing your very life -- which is no exaggeration. In short, the exact working through of cause and effect, of seeing results and connections, is the most essential aspect that makes the wanting to give up negativity possible. Without it, the motive never truly becomes strong enough. It is not sufficient to be aware of being deliberately destructive. It must be admitted that one does not want to give this up. It must be seen what price one pays. In this way, you become intensely and experientially connected with the cause of your negative creation and the effect it has on you. This bridge must be established. You must see very clearly that what renders you most unhappy -- your anxieties, your worries, your self-dislike, your insecurities, your discontent with life, your frustrations, your sense of wasting yourself and life, your hurt and your pain -- all these are direct effects and results of deliberately wanted negative attitudes. On step two, you are still separated from the effects. You may see the cause -- your destructiveness, you admit it, but you do not see its connection with all you deplore in your life. The connecting link between cause and effect is still absent. As long as this connecting link is not established, you cannot really want to give up the negativity. You must see the heavy price you pay, in order to be truly motivated to want to give it up. Giving up because you ought to, because you know it is somehow wrong or detrimental to you or others -- this vagueness will never do it. The specific link must be established. And this is an easier step than coming to step two.

I would say one of the most difficult inroads on this path is to reach step two: to be fully aware of your own negative creating by destructive attitudes of your own choosing. There is a world of difference between that state and the state before, when you project your unhappiness out into the world -- blame the world, blame others, and do not see the cause in you. You may still, even when you admit it first, blame others, but not to quite the same extent. Thus step two is of the most incisive importance. It means knowing your power, your selfhood. For to the degree you see this creative process in you in the negative, to that degree you gain an inkling of what you can do in order to produce beautiful life experiences. Step two may be the most difficult to reach. It certainly constitutes the most drastic change in self-perception and perception of life processes. But the

working through of step three is equal in importance, for without it, as I said, motivation is lacking. Step three is, however, not half as difficult and never meets up with as much resistance as step two.

When you begin to discover the same fascination with creating in the positive way as in the negative one -- only unmarred by suffering, guilt, fear, and self-blame -- the world opens up for you with such beauty and light that there are no words to describe it. You will taste the freedom of being creator of your chosen life.

In conjunction and in order to facilitate the realization of this connecting link -- and also as a very substantial part of your self-knowledge and self-acceptance -- you will recognize the unobstructed, unconcealed destructiveness and negativity behind facades of various kinds. For many years, we have discussed and worked on the pretenses, the defenses, the games and ploys, the idealized self-images, the specific forms of denial you seek in order to conceal your destructiveness. All these masks are hypocritical. They always display the opposite of what you reject and dislike in yourself. These cover-ups are actually infinitely more insidious and damaging than the actual destructiveness itself. For, once you face the naked destructiveness, you confront a truth in yourself. This gives you an honest choice of your future direction. But when you are still involved in the cover-ups, the roles and games, you cannot get at the core of your disturbance. Your suffering becomes worse, for you become alienated from the cause of your condition, and therefore you feel increasingly more disconnected and hopeless.

In order to hide from others, and primarily from yourself, you produce something that appears to be the opposite of what you wish to be hidden. The role becomes like second nature, but it has nothing to do with you. It is merely a habit you cannot shed as long as you are unwilling to look behind it. It is of specific importance that you disillusion yourself of the image you project into the world and of whose genuineness you try arduously to convince yourself of. The artificiality of this role you indulge in must be unmasked. It always appears to be good in some way, even by virtue of pretending you are a victim. But you must analyze it exactly and comprehend it in detail to see that it is none of what you pretend it is. It is never good; you are never that innocent, nor are others that villainous. But on the other hand, nor are you so hopelessly bad and unacceptable as you meanwhile believe you really are, underneath this role. For the role conveys the opposite not only of what you actually are, but also of what you believe you are.

Yet the pretended role contains the same aspects you so busily try to conceal. If you hide, and your role is that of being persecuted by the hate and unjust accusations of others, in this pretense lies the hate itself. The front or the role is never innately different from what it covers. It is a hating attitude to pretend being a victim of the hate of others. This is only one example. We shall discuss many others. The game itself must be disrobed, not only as to what it hides, but also as to its actual aspects and what they really mean. The negative energy is totally involved in this presented image. In order to make this clearer to you and have a more dynamic understanding of it, it is my suggestion, my friends, that you bring to me what your cover-up role is and what it hides. Anyone who has come that far in their work of self-discovery and has an awareness of the above should not hesitate -- even if it seems embarrassing at first -- and should present me with his personal finding in this respect. I will then proceed to help you see some of the ramifications, as discussed in this lecture, so as to help you faster along the way to changing the course of your life. This is well worth the apparent exposure. Such a direct and personal approach is so much better than my choosing random examples. It will also prove of help to other friends who have not yet come across their

own destructiveness and the cover under which they choose to conceal it. This can be done tonight after this lecture and next time in the question-and-answer session. Let us devote as much time as possible to the various roles you have chosen. Let us name these roles in simple sentences that describe what they are meant to convey. And I shall also show you how the very role -- supposed to be, for the most part, quite angelic -- is as destructive as what is concealed behind it. Indeed it could not be different, for you cannot hide the energy of soul currents. You cannot make them different by pretense, no matter how busily you try to make a charade out of your life.

The role or game you adopt in the illusion that it eliminates your deliberate destructiveness is the first layer that must be confronted. Then the various steps outlined can begin. Sometimes these steps overlap.

The more insight you have into the absolutely losing game you play with life when you hold on to the false role that covers up destructive attitudes, the more you will be motivated to give up all of this. Your will will be strengthened. This will lead you to the fourth step, which is the actual process of recreation of soul substance. By meditation, by prayer, by formulating deliberate thoughts of truth about this entire matter and impressing them onto your destructive psychic material, recreation begins and continues the more adept in it you become. When you discover again and again your will to be hating, unforgiving, punishing, resentful, and hurt, your attempt to exaggerate and drag out old injuries, your quite deliberate act of punishing others for what your parents did to you (or you think they did to you), your refusal to see their failures as anything but a deliberate act of hate against you, and when you then perceive that it gives you pleasure to dwell on all this within yourself and not to change your outlook and attitude at all, nor your feelings, it is then that you can begin to recreate. When you see the falsity of your pretenses, it is then that you can remind yourself of wanting to see what is underneath this facade of blame and victimization, in whatever guise it may appear in individual instances. Your feelings of being injured first appear as quite real, and it requires deeper probing to discover that they are not real at all. They are cultivated habits. So are the roles you play, which appear as your actual personality. Each objective acknowledgment of your pretenses -- the pretense of your role and the pretense of your sustained injuries as the cause of your negative emotions towards people and life experience -- enables you to want to be in deeper truth, to abandon those falsities, and to meet life with real and honest attitudes. The issuing of this intention and the calling upon the higher powers in you to help you is step four.

Another aspect of step four is the concise question to ask of your innermost being -- what can you use instead, in order to operate in life? How does it feel to bring forth better ways of responding to life's experiences? Something new will evolve. By this recreating process, healthy, resilient, adequate, truthful reactions will become your second nature, which you do not need to conceal with pretense. In this recreating process, formulate your sentences very concisely that what you do does not work and why it does not work and that you wish to operate in a different way. These sentences, if they are meant, have great creative power. They can be meant, they must be meant, when you fully comprehend what you are doing by remaining in your old attitudes.

These are the steps of purification in the deepest and most vital way. Purification is unthinkable without going through these steps. Purification is unthinkable without receiving active help. It is too difficult alone. It is utter illusion to hope, consciously or unconsciously, that facing these aspects of your being can be avoided, skipped, by-passed, or whisked away by some magic "spiritual" means. Self-realization, or self-actualization, or reaching your spiritual center -- or

whatever other name you wish to use in order to describe the goal of all living -- cannot occur unless you face your deepest negativities and hypocrisies, the deliberate intent to be negative and destructive, spiteful, and resentful, often to the degree of foregoing your own happiness just to punish someone of your past. This is painful, or at any rate, it first seems painful. But to the degree it is painful at first, to that degree it will prove liberating.

Here is where we are, my friends. And those of you who have not yet reached this realization of yourself on your individual path will come to it. You will have to know you must come to it and can prepare for it. For you cannot allow happiness into your soul, you cannot eliminate the pervasive guilt you seek to explain away by false guilts unless you go through these steps. No matter how much you now believe that others, or life's caprices, deprive you of what you desire, it is actually you who does this. For you can let in what life is always ready to give you so richly once you make room for it in your consciousness and your self-creating. Many are the people who want to reach spiritual heights but who harbor the unexpressed illusion that to face what I am discussing here can be avoided. They run from pillar to post, and whenever they are confronted with their own unpalatable truth, they run away. The imaginary need to run proves so illusory. There is no need to run away from yourself. Indeed there is no need to.

Whenever destructive attitudes remain unfaced and untouched, man lives in a most painful ambivalence. For he cannot ever go in one direction when he wants to be negative. There is always the real self clamoring for the ultimate reality and pulling into the opposite direction. Unification of inner direction can only exist when the personality is truly and genuinely constructive, without hidden destructiveness. And can you perceive of the pain of being split into two opposing directions? Perhaps the struggle of this is more painful and confusing, more paralyzing than anything else that goes on in the human psyche.

In order to reestablish the person you once were, before you became involved with negative creating -- long before this earth life -- in order to reexperience yourself as that which you essentially and ultimately are, that which you have always been and that which you will always be, you have to test and consider the possibility of positive creating. You will then see that it is really so much more natural and easy. It is an organic process, while the negative creating, the destructive attitudes are artificial and contrived even though you are now so used to them that they seem the more natural. The positive is effortless. Off hand, it seems that the effort is too great to abandon the negative that has become so much second nature to you. It seems that way because you still believe that by giving up negativity you create positivity as something new. If this were so, it would indeed be quite impossible in most instances. But the moment you realize that the positive creation is already there within you, only covered up, and that it can unfold and reveal itself the moment you allow for this to happen, abandoning negativity becomes a relief of a heavy burden that has pulled you down all your life -- and many lives before this one. When you hate, when you distrust, when you take a dim view of things, when you prevent a favorable outcome by expecting the worst, it already exists in you that you love, trust, know that life is good and can be trusted. All this and more exists already and must only be allowed out to the surface like the sun that comes out behind the clouds. You will see that it is possible to feel this underneath. Simultaneously you will experience the deep joy that permeates the entire being of a person when this discovery is being made. A few of my friends have already occasionally experienced this, and their way to recapture this ultimate reality will not be quite so difficult.

When we say that God is in man, this is what is meant. It is not only this fabulous consciousness with its infinite wisdom of the most personal order wherever you need it at the moment; not only the powers in the creative strength and energy; and not only the feelings of bliss, joy, pleasure supreme on all levels. All of this exists, of course. But also, right underneath where you are ill with your negativity, a new, old life exists in which all reactions to all possible contingencies are clear, strong, entirely right for each occasion, leaving you entirely satisfied. A resiliency and creativity of reacting already exists now, behind the false roles of pretense, behind the hold on destructiveness. Underneath your outer deadness, a bubbling aliveness exists already now. It will shine through at moments only, at first. But eventually it will manifest itself as your steady climate.

Before you can live in this steady climate, you will have to go through two basic phases that deal with the negativity that man is still involved with. Most human beings find themselves still in the first basic phase of negativity. This phase is initiating negativity. The second phase is responsive negativity. In the first phase, the person automatically responds to situations with the destructive pattern he has adopted after some traumatic experiences in early life. He maintains the negative responses which, at one time as a child, he could not avoid producing and which were then, under the circumstances, even life preserving. But when these same responses are repeated in later situations, when there is no cause for them, then such a response is not only what is being called "neurotic," it is also initiating negativity quite regardless of whether the other people involved act like the parents or not. The four steps I explained in this lecture are all destined to deal with this first phase. When more of my friends will approach the second phase, we shall discuss means to help you overcome negativity that is merely responsive, that is, such an individual has already freed himself from the initiating negativity and is clear in this respect. His reaction is positive whenever others do not react negatively toward him. But the negativity still flares up reactively, responsively as a result of the negativity of others. Now, you may say this is perfectly natural. For that matter, everything or anything is "perfectly natural." But it is still not the purified state. It is not the state of truth. For it is an illusion to have to respond in that way. Here, too, exists another, better way to respond. Even though the other person may indeed unload a great deal of unjustified hostility on you, it is an illusion to fear it and to then set up your negative defenses. You can defend yourself much more adequately without withdrawing, without becoming in any way defensive, without becoming destructive with your own feelings. There is no need to see life as bleak and hopeless because someone acts destructively toward you. So this responsive negativity must also be straightened out. But this can be done only after the initiating negativity has been wiped out. The vast majority of the human race, including all of you here to whom I talk, are still in the first phase. Whenever the slightest thing goes against your grain, whenever you experience any degree of frustration, you tend to bring in your original reactions of negativity. You even do this, in many instances, as a "precautionary" attitude just because you might experience frustration, delay, criticism, or the negativity of others.

Now, as well as at our next meeting, we shall discuss some of your own roles and games with which you cover your underlying destructive feelings and attitudes, and I shall help you see their self-defeating ramifications.

I think most of you can sense the importance of this lecture -- again, of course, only if you use it as your own and do not just consider it a theoretical discussion. Then it will prove of vital

significance in your evolutionary curve. Be blessed. Love and strength is given forth for everyone here.

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